

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 586

By Gardenhire

A RESOLUTION to commend Deborah Kerley DeBord for her service as Bledsoe County Clerk and Master.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that we should specially recognize those estimable public servants who have dedicated themselves to improving the quality of life for their fellow citizens; and

WHEREAS, one such individual is Deborah Kerley DeBord, who evinced the greatest integrity and probity as the Bledsoe County Clerk and Master before taking her well-deserved retirement on June 30, 2025; and

WHEREAS, Debbie DeBord began her career in the office of the Bledsoe County Clerk and Master in the position of Deputy Clerk and Master in June 1983 and served with distinction in that capacity until December 31, 2018; and

WHEREAS, Mrs. DeBord was appointed to serve as Bledsoe County Clerk and Master by the Honorable Melissa Thomas Willis on January 1, 2019, and rendered a total of forty-two years of sterling service with the office; and

WHEREAS, Mrs. DeBord was a member of the Tennessee Association of Property Tax Professionals and served as ADA Coordinator from January 1, 2019, through June 30, 2025; and

WHEREAS, born on July 27, 1964, Debbie DeBord is the daughter of Dewey and Wanda Kerley; she grew up in the Melvine community and is a member of the First Families of Bledsoe County; and

WHEREAS, she attended Pikeville Elementary School and graduated from Bledsoe County High School in 1982; and

WHEREAS, a woman of devout faith, Mrs. DeBord is a member of the Church of God, where she has served as a Sunday School teacher for thirty years; and

WHEREAS, Debbie DeBord has been grateful for the love and companionship she shares with her husband, Martin Dwayne DeBord, and their children and their families: son, Matthew DeBord, and his wife, Shauna; their children, Raylan "Colt" DeBord, Cadence "Jake" DeBord, Lincoln Dwayne DeBord, and Sawyer Lynn DeBord; and son, Tyler DeBord, and his wife, Haylee; and

WHEREAS, Mrs. DeBord is wholly committed to the noble precepts of public service that have earned Tennessee recognition as the Volunteer State, and she should be specially recognized; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we commend Deborah Kerley DeBord for her honorable and astute service as Bledsoe County Clerk and Master and wish her every continued success and happiness during her retirement.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.